Heavy rainfall causes flooding in several parts of Central America.

During the past week, rainfall totals ranging from 100 mm to 300 mm were recorded across many parts of Guatemala, most of Belize, western and eastern Honduras, northeastern and eastern Nicaragua, the Pacific-facing region of Costa Rica, and western and central Panama. Other areas of the region received between 10 mm and 100 mm of rainfall. These heavy rainfall events caused flooding and damage in several areas. Positive rainfall anomalies of 50–200 mm were recorded in several parts of Central America. In contrast, rainfall deficits of 25–100 mm were observed in northern Honduras, coastal areas of El Salvador, parts of western Nicaragua, coastal areas of Costa Rica along the Caribbean Sea, and coastal areas of Panama. Over the past 30 days, erratic rainfall patterns have maintained deficits of 50–80% of normal in localized areas, including northern Belize, El Salvador, the Gulf of Fonseca region, western Costa Rica, and central and eastern Panama. Over the past 90 days, rainfall deficits have continued to exceed 200 mm in western Guatemala, northern Belize, El Salvador, western Nicaragua, western Costa Rica, and most of Panama. Maximum temperatures were 1–4°C above average across Central America. Erratic rainfall distribution since the beginning of the Postrera and second rainy seasons, combined with above-average temperatures, has negatively affected soil moisture, vegetation health, and water availability. For example, river levels are currently low, contributing to power outages in several areas and economic losses in the agricultural sector.

During the outlook period, heavy rainfall is expected to continue across Central America. The highest rainfall totals (100–200 mm) are forecast in Guatemala, Belize, eastern Honduras, northeastern Nicaragua, and parts of Costa Rica. Mean temperature anomalies of 2–4°C, are expected in localized areas along the Pacific-tier of Central America. Abnormal heat risks are expected in areas where maximum temperatures are forecast to exceed the 90th percentile for at least three consecutive days.

Week 1 GEFS Rainfall Total Forecast and GEFS Rainfall Anomaly Forecast (mm)
15 October – 21 October 2026

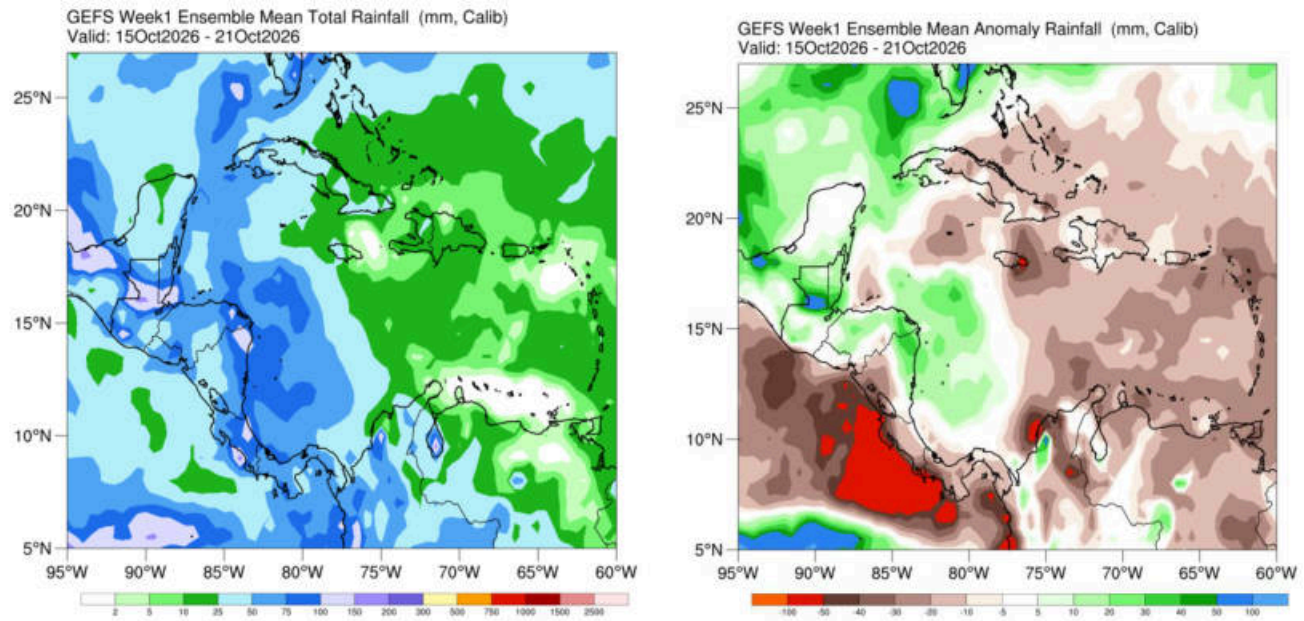


Figure 1: Source NOAA / CPC